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(7) Sector/Commodity	(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization Education – Social Science
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(9A) Abstract

Orientation services are an important part of school guidance programs. These services attempt to promote the effective transition of students across year levels and between schools, and one orientation is the student handbook.

This study aimed to determine the level of awareness of college students towards the code of discipline under the 2022 Enhanced Edition Student Handbook. The research used a descriptive correlation method and a researcher-made questionnaire to gather data from 292 students. The majority of respondents were first-year students aged 21-24 years, predominantly female, enrolled in a Bachelor of Science in Criminology program, and had a monthly family income ranging from PhP 5,000 to PhP 10,000. No significant differences in awareness levels were found based on age and year level, but significant differences were observed based on sex, course, and monthly family income. The overall level of awareness was labeled as "moderately aware" with a mean level of 4.1392.

The study highlights the importance of implementing an intensive campaign and orientation on the Code of Discipline in fostering an environment of respect and responsibility in educational environments.

(9B) Keywords

awareness, code of discipline, student handbook

Introduction

Student Handbooks are designed to serve as the primary source of guidance and reference for the students regarding pertinent school background, academics, extra-curricular involvement, policies and regulations, services, and laws relevant to students. It is one of every student's duty to read it sensibly to make the university or institution enjoyable, significant, and productive (Kershaw & Carback, 2020). Moreover, the student handbook provides students with information, guidelines, and policies that will enhance their adjustments as part of the community of their school. According to George Fox University (2015), "One of the key documents that outline the students' experience is the Student Handbook. This defines our community who we are, what we're about, what we believe, how we live and journey together, and the expectations for those who have chosen to become members of our community," and stated that "the students' handbook is important for student to read and understand, so they can fully engage in all facets of being a student (Salazar, 2019).

The students are the University's prime stakeholders, molded by the core values that strive to exemplify the foundation of all actions. A God-centered student who works for excellence adheres to the highest standard of integrity, lives in transparency with accountability, and is dedicated to inclusive quality service for all. Moreover, the University will prepare and instill the right mindset of a better young Filipino that focuses on the spirit of optimism that they can stride and move forward despite the ambiguity and complexity of life (Excerpt from the 2022 Enhanced Edition Student Handbook).

Nonetheless, the institution's consideration is to provide inclusive rules and regulations to be implemented. Also, the University expands its purview regarding the services it offers for the unprivileged but deserving students of Capiz State University. This is due to the University's commitment to not just fulfilling its duty but also to the best interests of its students for their holistic development and welfare (Excerpt from the 2022 Enhanced Edition Student Handbook).

The Student Handbook, prepared by the CapSU Administration, is a comprehensive explanation of all issues concerning students' participation in the University's activities. It outlines the steps that students must follow to carry out their diverse objectives about university life with ease and purpose. It is with great desire that the researcher was interested in determining specifically the level of awareness of students on the code of discipline despite the orientation programs done by the campus every opening of the academic year.

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(11) Materials and Methods or Methodology

This descriptive-correlational research, particularly associational, used 292 students enrolled at Capiz State University Dumarao Satellite College during the Second Semester, School Year 2023-2024, and were selected using stratified random sampling.

A researcher-made questionnaire was used to gather relevant data. The first part consisted of the socio-demographic profile of the respondents while the second part was on the statements on the awareness of student's basic rights, student's duties and responsibilities, rules and regulations on conduct and discipline, and dismissal or expulsion. The instrument underwent a pilot test and was approved to be utilized for the conduct of the study upon passing the reliability test. The collected data were encoded in Microsoft Excel and processed in the SPSS software for analysis

(12) Results and Discussions

Level of Awareness on Code of Discipline

Table 1.0 shows the level of awareness of students on code of discipline. Data revealed that the respondents got an entire group mean level of 4.1392 with a standard deviation of 1.13359 categorized as "moderately aware".

The awareness of the Code of Discipline among senior-year students, particularly those aged 25-28 years old, female, pursuing degrees in Doctor of Veterinary Medicine (DVM) and Bachelor of Secondary Education (BSED), is an area of considerable significance. This demographic, characterized by a monthly family income exceeding Php 10,000.00, demonstrates a comparable level of awareness regarding disciplinary codes when juxtaposed with other subgroups within the academic environment. Their financial background may suggest access to resources that facilitate better understanding and adherence to institutional policies.

Moreover, the educational trajectory for DVM and BSED students inherently involves rigorous training that emphasizes ethical standards and professional conduct. This context fosters an environment where awareness of disciplinary codes becomes integral to their academic experience. The similarities in awareness levels across various subgroups indicate that factors such as age, gender, and financial status may not significantly influence comprehension or engagement with the Code of Discipline. Instead, it implies that shared educational experiences cultivate a uniform understanding among students.

Table 1.0 Mean level of awareness on code of discipline when taken as a whole and when grouped according to socio-demographic profile.

Socio-demographic Profile	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Entire Group	4.1392	1.13359	Moderately Aware
Age			
17-20 years old	4.1372	1.35550	Moderately Aware
21-24 years old	4.1198	.69712	Moderately Aware
25-28 years old	4.4128	.59924	Fully Aware
Sex			
Male	3.9333	.94399	Moderately Aware
Female	4.2448	1.20818	Fully Aware
Course			
DVM	4.6623	.21317	Fully Aware
BS Agriculture	3.6626	.98827	Moderately Aware
BS Criminology	4.0122	1.57536	Moderately Aware
BEED	4.0997	.49868	Moderately Aware

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BSED Science	4.6660	.91057	Fully Aware
BSED Social Studies	4.3289	.34400	Fully Aware
Year Level			
1st Year	4.0018	.75956	Moderately Aware
2nd Year	4.1725	1.78055	Moderately Aware
3rd Year	4.1342	.97951	Moderately Aware
4th Year	4.2323	.50676	Fully Aware
5th Year	4.8880	.07124	Fully Aware
6th Year	4.6715	.17610	Fully Aware
Monthly Family Income			
Below Php. 5,000.00	4.1105	.60789	Moderately Aware
Php. 5,000.00-10,000.00	4.0139	.82513	Moderately Aware
More than Php.10,000.00	4.4809	1.74133	Fully Aware

Level of Awareness on Students' Basic Rights

Table 1.1 shows the level of awareness of the respondents on students' basic rights. Data revealed that the respondents got an entire group mean level of 4.1136 with a standard deviation of 0.73737 inferred as "moderately aware".

The analysis of data regarding the awareness of students' basic rights among various demographics has yielded significant insights, particularly within the subgroup of 25-28-year-old female students enrolled in Doctor of Veterinary Medicine (DVM) and Bachelor of Secondary Education (BSED) programs. This demographic, identified as being in their senior year and possessing a monthly family income exceeding Php 10,000.00, exhibited a comparable level of awareness to other subgroups surveyed. Such findings underscore the importance of considering both educational background and socio-economic status when evaluating awareness levels pertaining to student rights.

The comparable awareness levels suggest that factors such as age and gender may not significantly influence the understanding of basic rights among these students. It is noteworthy that both DVM and BSED programs have distinct curricular focuses; however, this does not appear to create a disparity in knowledge regarding fundamental rights. This indicates that institutional frameworks within these educational environments likely promote similar levels of engagement with issues surrounding student rights, thereby fostering an inclusive atmosphere for all students regardless of their specific field of study.

Table 1.1. Mean level of awareness on students' basic rights when taken as a whole and when grouped according to socio-demographic profile.

Socio-demographic Profile	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Entire Group	4.1136	.73737	Moderately Aware
Age			
17-20 years old	4.1197	.77246	Moderately Aware
21-24 years old	4.0861	.68652	Moderately Aware
25-28 years old	4.3278	.67011	Fully Aware
Sex			
Male	4.0015	.84897	Moderately Aware
Female	4.1710	.66813	Moderately Aware
Course			

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DVM	4.6649	.26987	Fully Aware
BS Agriculture	3.7515	.81105	Moderately Aware
BS Criminology	3.9060	.81624	Moderately Aware
BEED	4.0167	.45101	Moderately Aware
BSED Science	4.5369	.47381	Fully Aware
BSED Social Studies	4.4059	.38117	Fully Aware
Year Level			
1st Year	4.0616	.79372	Moderately Aware
2nd Year	4.1074	.75181	Moderately Aware
3rd Year	4.0734	.80872	Moderately Aware
4th Year	4.1514	.48629	Moderately Aware
5th Year	4.8925	.13793	Fully Aware
6th Year	4.7975	.10689	Fully Aware
Monthly Family Income			
Below Php. 5,000.00	4.0214	.68676	Moderately Aware
Php. 5,000.00-10,000.00	4.0777	.74487	Moderately Aware
More than Php.10,000.00	4.2353	.72634	Fully Aware

Level of Awareness on Students' Duties and Responsibilities

Table 1.2 shows the level of awareness of the respondents on students' duties and responsibilities. Data revealed that the respondents got an entire group mean level of 4.2002 with a standard deviation of 0.78659 interpreted as "moderately aware". Specifically, focusing on female students aged 25-28 years enrolled in Doctor of Veterinary Medicine (DVM) and Bachelor of Secondary Education (BSEd) programs reveals significant insights. These students, categorized by their first, third, and senior year levels and with a monthly family income exceeding Php 10,000.00, demonstrate a comparable level of awareness concerning their academic obligations and roles within the educational environment.

Table 1.2. Mean level of awareness on students' duties and responsibilities when taken as a whole and when grouped according to socio-demographic profile.

Socio-demographic Profile	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Entire Group	4.2002	.78659	Moderately Aware
Age			
17-20 years old	4.2037	.80432	Moderately Aware
21-24 years old	4.1764	.77043	Moderately Aware
25-28 years old	4.4200	.66387	Fully Aware
Sex			
Male	4.0640	.90997	Moderately Aware
Female	4.2700	.70756	Fully Aware
Course			
DVM	4.6509	.36502	Fully Aware
BS Agriculture	3.9174	1.00266	Moderately Aware

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BS Criminology	3.9913	.85806	Moderately Aware
BEED	4.1054	.48750	Moderately Aware
BSED Science	4.5262	.43044	Fully Aware
BSED Social Studies	4.5470	.35946	Fully Aware
Year Level			
1st Year	4.2207	.77166	Fully Aware
2nd Year	4.1083	.85578	Moderately Aware
3rd Year	4.2193	.87110	Fully Aware
4th Year	4.1875	.59553	Moderately Aware
5th Year	5.0000	.00000	Fully Aware
6th Year	4.5550	.27489	Fully Aware
Monthly Family Income			
Below Php. 5,000.00	4.1438	.72030	Moderately Aware
Php. 5,000.00-10,000.00	4.1506	.81182	Moderately Aware
More than Php.10,000.00	4.3482	.72454	Fully Aware

Level of Awareness on Rules and Regulations on Conduct and Discipline

Table 1.3 shows the level of awareness of the respondents on rules and regulations on conduct and discipline. Data revealed that the respondents got an entire group mean level ($M=4.1678$; $sd=0.82863$) described as “moderately aware”. In addition, female students aged 25-28 who are pursuing degrees in Doctor of Veterinary Medicine (DVM) and Bachelor of Science in Education (BSED) during their senior year exhibit a noteworthy level of awareness comparable to other subgroups. This finding suggests that socioeconomic factors, such as family income, may play a role in shaping student perceptions and understanding of institutional policies.

Table 1.3. Mean level of awareness on rules and regulations on conduct and discipline when taken as a whole and when grouped as to socio-demographic profile.

Socio-demographic Profile	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Entire Group	4.1678	.82863	Moderately Aware
Age			
17-20 years old	4.1610	.83452	Moderately Aware
21-24 years old	4.1466	.82854	Moderately Aware
25-28 years old	4.5556	.68739	Fully Aware
Sex			
Male	4.0234	1.01293	Moderately Aware
Female	4.2419	.70761	Fully Aware
Course			
DVM	4.6284	.35109	Fully Aware
BS Agriculture	3.8711	1.03408	Moderately Aware
BS Criminology	4.0132	.92861	Moderately Aware
BEED	4.1658	.50141	Moderately Aware
BSED Science	4.5777	.40622	Fully Aware

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BSED Social Studies	4.2608	.58855	Fully Aware
Year Level			
1st Year	4.1440	.76620	Moderately Aware
2nd Year	4.1212	.88740	Moderately Aware
3rd Year	4.1716	.95095	Moderately Aware
4th Year	4.1961	.70622	Moderately Aware
5th Year	4.7500	.32031	Fully Aware
6th Year	4.5825	.50056	Fully Aware
Monthly Family Income			
Below Php. 5,000.00	4.2067	.89749	Moderately Aware
Php. 5,000.00-10,000.00	4.1235	.85927	Moderately Aware
More than Php.10,000.00	4.2747	.71882	Fully Aware

Level of Awareness on Dismissal or Expulsion

Table 1.4 shows the level of awareness of the respondents on dismissal or expulsion. Data revealed that the respondents got an entire group mean level ($M=4.1784$; $sd=3.29537$) classified as “moderately aware”. In particular, female students aged 17-20 and 25-28 enrolled in Doctor of Veterinary Medicine (DVM) and Bachelor of Secondary Education (BSED) programs had a comparable level of awareness on dismissal or expulsion with the rest of the subgroups. The data indicates that these two age groups, specifically those in their second and senior years, exhibit similar levels of awareness on the subject matter despite potential differences in academic maturity and life experiences.

Table 1.4. Mean level of awareness on dismissal or expulsion when taken as a whole and when grouped as to socio-demographic profile.

Socio-demographic Profile	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Entire Group	4.1784	3.29537	Moderately Aware
Age			
17-20 years old	4.2370	4.19674	Fully Aware
21-24 years old	4.0707	.99817	Moderately Aware
25-28 years old	4.3511	.65064	Fully Aware
Sex			
Male	3.7966	1.16209	Moderately Aware
Female	4.3743	3.95675	Fully Aware
Course			
DVM	4.7070	.29803	Fully Aware
BS Agriculture	3.5929	1.00757	Moderately Aware
BS Criminology	4.1385	5.26839	Moderately Aware
BEED	4.1104	.86584	Moderately Aware
BSED Science	4.5258	3.13731	Fully Aware
BSED Social Studies	4.1019	.92612	Fully Aware
Year Level			

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1st Year	3.7497	.93208	Moderately Aware
2nd Year	4.5496	5.95363	Fully Aware
3rd Year	4.0732	2.24741	Moderately Aware
4th Year	4.3955	.61300	Fully Aware
5th Year	4.9125	.08808	Fully Aware
6th Year	4.7525	.07500	Fully Aware
Monthly Family Income			
Below Php. 5,000.00	4.0719	.48865	Moderately Aware
Php. 5,000.00-10,000.00	3.8564	1.09308	Moderately Aware
More than Php.10,000.00	4.2658	6.23975	Fully Aware

Difference on the Level of Awareness on Code of Discipline according to Socio-demographic Profile of the Respondents

Table 2.0 shows the difference on the level of awareness on code of discipline when classified according to socio-demographic profile of the respondents. The study highlights the importance of understanding the factors that influence students' awareness levels towards the code of discipline. The study found no significant differences in awareness levels towards the code of discipline based on age and year level. However, significant differences in awareness levels were observed based on sex, course, and monthly family income.

The findings supports the study of Zondo et.al 2022 that underscored the importance of ongoing support and guidance for teachers in utilizing the code of conduct to address student misbehavior effectively. This support could help create a more conducive learning environment and promote positive discipline within schools. Their study emphasized the need for a collaborative effort between schools, teachers, and education authorities to ensure the successful implementation of disciplinary measures and the promotion of positive behavior among students.

The research of Lindsay, 2008 underscores the complex dynamics at play in the realm of university discipline, emphasizing the need for a nuanced understanding of the factors contributing to academic misconduct and the challenges in upholding academic integrity within evolving educational landscapes.

The study of Yun, 2005 underscores the significance of creating a supportive and nurturing environment for discipline to thrive. This involves not only structural aspects such as faculty development and resource allocation but also cultural elements that promote a shared commitment to academic excellence and integrity.

Table 2.0. Difference on the level of awareness as to socio-demographic profile.

Socio-demographic Profile	Mean	t/F	Sig (Two-tailed)	Decision
Age				
17-20 years old	4.1372			
21-24 years old	4.1198	.277	.758	Retain the null hypothesis
25-28 years old	4.4128			
Sex				
Male	3.9333	5.009	.026	Reject the null hypothesis
Female	4.2448			
Course				
DVM	4.6623 ^b			
BS Agriculture	3.6626 ^a			
BS Criminology	4.0122 ^a	6.103	.000	Reject the null hypothesis
BEED	4.0997 ^a			
BSED Science	4.6660 ^b			

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BSED Social Studies	4.3289 ^{ab}			
Year Level				
1st Year	4.0018			
2nd Year	4.1725			
3rd Year	4.1342	.864	.505	Retain the null hypothesis
4th Year	4.2323			
5th Year	4.8880			
6th Year	4.6715			
Monthly Family Income				
Below Php. 5,000.00	4.1105 ^a			
Php. 5,000.00-10,000.00	4.0139 ^a	4.688	.010	Reject the null hypothesis
More than Php.10,000.00	4.4809 ^b			

(13) Conclusions

- Most of the respondents were in the first-year level, aged 21-24 years, female, enrolled in a Bachelor of Science in Criminology program, and had a monthly family income ranging from Php 5,000 to Php 10,000. It was evident that while respondents had some knowledge about the student code of discipline, there was room for improvement in terms of awareness and understanding. Although most understood the basic rules, there appeared to be a lack of awareness regarding other aspects of the code.
- The level of awareness of the student code of discipline varied among different age groups. Some argued that older individuals might have a better understanding and adherence to the code due to their life experiences and maturity. However, results showed that there was no significant correlation between age and the level of awareness of the code of discipline.
- There was a significant correlation between sex and the level of awareness of the code of discipline, with females generally exhibiting a higher level of awareness. This correlation could be attributed to various factors, including societal norms, upbringing, and personal values. One possible explanation was the traditional gender roles assigned to males and females, where females were often expected to adhere to stricter codes of conduct compared to males.
- It was evident that students in certain courses, such as Doctor of Veterinary Medicine, teacher education, and criminology, had a higher level of awareness of the importance of following a code of discipline. These programs emphasized ethical behavior and professional conduct, directly influencing their understanding and compliance with institutional rules. In contrast, students in technical or creative fields may prioritize technical skills or creativity over understanding institutional rules.
- There was no significant correlation between year level and the level of awareness of the code of discipline. Students from different year levels showed varying degrees of familiarity with the rules outlined in the code, suggesting that factors other than year level influenced students' awareness.

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6. Individuals with higher monthly family incomes tended to have greater access to resources such as education and information, contributing to a higher level of awareness of social norms and expectations. Conversely, those with lower incomes may have had limited access to such resources, potentially leading to a lower level of awareness.

Recommendations

1. The school administration is encouraged to maintain the intensive campaign and orientation on the code of discipline as it helps foster a culture of respect and responsibility among students, reinforces the importance of ethical behavior, and instills a sense of accountability in each individual;
2. Faculty may integrate the code of discipline into their classes. This code serves as a set of guidelines that outline expected behavior and consequences for misconduct, helping to create a sense of order and respect among students. By setting clear expectations for behavior, faculty members can establish a foundation for mutual respect and cooperation within the classroom. This not only fosters a more productive learning environment but also helps students develop important life skills such as self-discipline and accountability;
3. Students are encouraged to familiarize the code of discipline as it plays a vital role in shaping their character and behavior. By embracing these guidelines, they not only uphold the standards of their institution but also cultivate essential traits that will serve them well in their future endeavors; and
4. Future studies related to this may be conducted.

(14) Output

Baseline information for the study of awareness on student handbook.

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes, or services transferred as extension activities)

(16) Economic Analysis (This should present the direct cost of project implementation, expenses in the production of technology, revenues generated from technology produced, return on investment (ROI) and payback period.

(17) Acknowledgments (Include only important persons and institutions with involvement in funding and conduct of the research. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

(18) References

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